

OFF-ROAD ADVENTURERS

These cars are specially built to travel along difficult terrain, such as muddy or very uneven roads. They are also known as "four-by-fours" because all four wheels are powered by the engine. This gives each wheel the ability to pull the vehicle out of a sticky position.



WILLYS MB JEEP
1941



LAND ROVER SERIES 1
1949



MERCEDES-BENZ G300D
1993



RANGE ROVER
2002



HUMMER H3
2008



MCLAREN F1 GT
1997



BUGATTI VEYRON
2005



KOENIGSEGG
AGERA RS
2015



LAMBORGHINI
HURACÁN
2014



PORSCHE 918
SPYDER
2015

RACING DEMONS

Racing cars come in several shapes and sizes. Each one is built to suit a particular kind of race, such as Formula 1, rallying, endurance, or stock car racing.



FORMULA 1 RACING: 2008 MCLAREN-MERCEDES
Driven by 2008 World Champion Lewis Hamilton.



TOURING CAR RACING: 2003 MERCEDES BENZ
This won nine of the ten races in Germany's Touring Car Masters (DTM).



ENDURANCE RACING: 2009 PEUGEOT
Winner of Le Mans 24-hour race; driven by a team of three.



STOCK CAR RACING: 2009 TOYOTA CAMRY
Brian Vickers won the Carfax 400 in this hybrid car.



RALLYING: 2000 SUBARU IMPREZA
Winner of the Safari Rally; driven by Richard Burns.

THE FUTURE IS GREEN

Hybrid cars have two kinds of energy sources: a petrol or diesel engine and an electric motor. When the car is using the petrol or diesel engine, it also charges up the electric motor, which can then be used to drive. These cars use less energy and cause less pollution than other cars.



FORD ESCAPE HYBRID
2009

New York City, USA, is now using more and more hybrid taxicabs.



TESLA ROADSTER
2007

This car is purely electric.



BMW i8
2014

This hybrid sports car can reach speeds of up to 250 km/h (155 mph).

RECORD BREAKERS

Over the years, manufacturers have tried to outdo each other with new refinements. Here are some remarkable record-breaking cars.

FIRST AFFORDABLE CAR

In the early years of motoring, cars were driven only by wealthy people. Henry Ford changed this in 1908, when he produced the affordable Model T.

FORD
MODEL T



LAND SPEED RECORD

Thrust SSC (SuperSonic Car) used two turbojets to drive faster than sound in 1997 in the Nevada Desert, USA, reaching 1,228 km/h (763 mph).



THRUST SSC

SMALLEST ROADWORTHY CAR

Built by Austin Colson in the USA in 2012, this car measures just 63.5 cm (25 in) high x 65.41 cm (25.8 in) wide x 126.47 cm (50 in) long. It is just big enough to be allowed on roads.

MOST EXPENSIVE CAR

In 2013 Lamborghini unveiled the world's most expensive car: the Veneno Roadster. It costs £3.3 million (US\$4.95 million) and has a top speed of 356 km/h (221 mph). Lamborghini said that only nine cars would ever be produced.

FASTEST PRODUCTION CAR

The fastest series production car is the Hennessey Venom GT. It reached a speed of 435.31 km/h (270.49 mph) in 2014, and is powered by a 7.0-litre, twin-turbo V8 engine.

Mercedes-Benz
300 SL "Gull Wing"



1959

The space-saving, compact Mini changes thinking about economy cars.

Mini



1971

Chrysler Imperial introduces a reliable electronic four-wheel anti-lock braking system, called Sure-Brake.

1982

Bosch produces the first fully digital electronic fuel injection system.



Fuel injection system

2014

Hennessey Venom does 435 km/h (270.49 mph).

1958

Aston Martin DB4 achieves 227 km/h (141 mph).

1966

Lamborghini Miura reaches 275 km/h (171 mph).

1973

Catalytic converter invented.

1997

Toyota Prius is the first mass-produced hybrid car.

2010

Bugatti Veyron 16.4 Super Sport does 434 km/h (269.86 mph).



Aston Martin DB4



Lamborghini Miura



Catalytic converter



Toyota Prius

2015